

MARK MCMANUS

Senior / Lead Games QA | Embedded QA | Technical QA

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior / Lead Games QA professional with 9+ years of experience across AAA, AA and independent development. Experienced in embedded and lead QA, test strategy, defect management, release readiness, stakeholder reporting and mentoring across PC, console, mobile and VR. Strong technical background partnering with engineering from feature validation through release, and a Humans in Games board member representing the QA profession.

CORE QA EXPERTISE

- QA leadership and ownership across test strategy, planning, prioritisation, defect triage, stakeholder reporting and mentoring.
- Functional, regression, compatibility, performance, usability and UI / UX testing across PC, PlayStation, Xbox, Switch, iOS, Android and VR.
- End-to-end test design and risk-based coverage, from requirements and feature validation through release readiness and sign-off support.
- Technical investigation using logs, profiling, APIs, CI, Perforce / Jira and scripted or automated testing to isolate complex issues.
- Close collaboration with engineering, design, production and external QA teams to improve quality, coverage and development workflows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Platforms	PC, PlayStation, Xbox, Switch, iOS, Android, VR, Stadia, Luna
Engines	CryEngine / StarEngine, Unity, Unreal Engine
QA & Development	Jira, TestRail, Perforce, Git, DevTrack, Jenkins / CI
Technical Testing	API testing, profiling, log analysis, ADB / Android Studio, Xcode, Charles / Proxyman

SELECTED GAME CREDITS

Star Citizen • Squadron 42 • Fall Guys (Mobile) • Merge Dragons! • HYENAS • The Dark Pictures Anthology: Man of Medan & Little Hope • My Time at Portia • Hidden Agenda • The Inpatient • Bravo Team • LEGO City Undercover • LEGO Dimensions • Alex Kidd in Miracle World DX

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Embedded QA Specialist – Tools • Cloud Imperium Games Oct 2025 – Present

- Primary embedded QA specialist supporting Engine and Tools teams on Star Citizen and Squadron 42, partnering directly with engineers to investigate proprietary tools, backend systems and development workflows.
- Own test coverage for development tools, creating and maintaining targeted test cases and QA knowledge to improve stability across the content creation pipeline.
- Act as the main QA contact for Tools support, communicating risks, progress and test status to leadership and distributed development teams.
- Use Perforce, Jira and technical investigation to isolate conflicts, reproduce complex issues and help developers reach faster resolutions.

Director • Ki10 Games Apr 2024 – Present

- Lead design, programming and QA on independent game projects, taking systems from prototype through iterative development and platform-focused testing.
- Own implementation, debugging, optimisation and third-party integrations while refining player experience against feedback and project goals.
- Define test plans, defect workflows and QA documentation covering known issues, test environments and platform-specific behaviour.

Senior Mobile QA Tester · Unity

Nov 2023 – Apr 2024

- Led QA across high-profile iOS and Android projects including Merge Dragons! and Fall Guys (Mobile), covering stability, performance and release readiness.
- Owned end-to-end testing from requirements and test design through device fragmentation, performance, memory, battery and responsiveness coverage.
- Produced QA reports and dashboards, provided actionable risk insight and supported final sign-off and go / no-go release decisions.
- Mentored junior testers and improved test documentation, bug reporting standards and player-experience focused test sessions.
- Validated Apple App Store and Google Play requirements, including platform compliance, privacy and security.

Senior QA Tester · The Breach Studios

Apr 2023 – Nov 2023

- Led and coordinated QA on Robo Kiden, owning test execution and quality standards across project milestones.
- Designed end-to-end test strategies for internal and external QA, defining scenarios, cases, procedures and cross-platform coverage.
- Managed defect tracking, workload prioritisation and status reporting, providing clear quality and risk updates to management.
- Partnered with development stakeholders across gameplay, UI / UX, narrative and performance, and fed QA learning into retrospectives.

QA Tester · 22cans

Nov 2021 – Apr 2023

- Primary QA contact embedded within the Legacy development team, maintaining fast feedback loops and issue resolution throughout production.
- Developed targeted strategies for gameplay, simulation and progression systems and managed the defect lifecycle from triage through verification.
- Coordinated external QA priorities and provided continuous design and user-experience feedback to support iteration.

EARLIER CAREER

QA Tester · Merge Games	Mar 2021 – Nov 2021
Smalland · Monster Harvest · FORECLOSED · Alex Kidd in Miracle World DX	
QA Technician · Creative Assembly	Apr 2020 – Mar 2021
HYENAS	
Development QA Tester · Supermassive Games	Feb 2019 – Feb 2020
Man of Medan · Little Hope	
QA Tester · Team17	May 2018 – Sep 2018
QA Tester · Sony WWSQA / Supermassive Games	May 2017 – Jan 2018
Hidden Agenda · The Inpatient · Bravo Team	
QA Tester · T.T. Games	Mar 2016 – May 2017
LEGO Dimensions · LEGO City Undercover	

INDUSTRY INVOLVEMENT

- Board Member · Humans in Games
- Represent the games QA profession on the board of Humans in Games, a games industry charity.

QUALIFICATIONS

Games Development Level 4 & 5 · Hopwood Hall College	2015
BTEC Level 3 Games Development · Hopwood Hall College	2013